新可乐的 79 天

The 79 Days of New Coke



盲测胜出的新可乐，为什么遭到反对？

英文原文

Pepsi had set up booths in shopping centres across the US, inviting shoppers to sip two unmarked beverages and state a preference. Figures varied by region, but tasters generally picked Pepsi more often. Each stall, letting consumers judge by palate alone, doubled as publicity.

Coca-Cola's testing was thorough and extensive. Nearly 200,000 blind taste tests showed a sweeter formula beating the original and Pepsi. On 23 April 1985 the company announced it would replace its 99-year-old syrup, a year short of its centenary. The public called the soda New Coke. Its sweetness had given it a winning flavour, but launching the concoction was a wager.

The backlash was a grassroots outcry. Consumer hotline calls rose from about 400 a day to about 1,500, almost all furious complaints. Protest groups were organised, and some faithful drinkers stocked up on the original. In June 1985 one protester, Gay Mullins, filed a lawsuit to keep New Coke out of packaging like the original's. Its dismissal came a week later.

Pepsi's chief executive gave his employees a day off, treating the change as Coke's concession. After 79 days, on 11 July 1985, the original formula was relaunched as Coca-Cola Classic. The U-turn was a vindication for loyalists. ABC interrupted a soap opera to broadcast the comeback, which led two network news bulletins.

Coca-Cola had misjudged what the tests measured. They captured a mouthful, not the emotional attachment that nearly a century of familiarity had built. To many, the old taste carried nostalgia and heritage. The tests had hidden the brand from every taster, so they could not quantify what it meant to fiercely loyal drinkers.

中文译文

百事可乐曾在全美各地的购物中心设置摊位，请购物者小口品尝两种未标明品牌的饮料，并说出自己更喜欢哪一种。结果因地区而异，但品尝者总体上选择百事的次数更多。这些让消费者只凭味觉判断的摊位，同时也起着宣传作用。

可口可乐的测试既细致又广泛。近二十万次盲测显示，一种更甜的配方比原配方和百事更受欢迎。1985年4月23日，公司宣布，要更换使用了99年的糖浆配方，此时距它的百年诞辰只差一年。公众把这种汽水称为“新可乐”。甜味让它在口味比较中胜出，但推出这种调制饮料，却是一场冒险。

随之而来的是民众自发的强烈反对。消费者热线每天接到的电话，从约400通增至约1500通，几乎全是愤怒的投诉。抗议团体组织起来，一些忠实消费者开始囤积原版可乐。1985年6月，抗议者盖伊·马林斯提起诉讼，要求禁止新可乐使用与原版相似的包装。一周后，这项诉讼被驳回。

百事首席执行官把对手改换配方视为可口可乐的让步，给员工放了一天假。79天后，也就是1985年7月11日，原配方以“可口可乐经典”的名称重新上市。这次转向，让原配方的忠实拥护者觉得自己的坚持得到了证明。ABC电视台中断一部肥皂剧，播报原配方回归的消息；这条消息还成了两家电视网新闻节目的头条。

可口可乐误判了测试究竟衡量到了什么。测试捕捉到的是一小口饮料的味道，却没有测出近一个世纪的熟悉感所累积的情感依恋。对许多人而言，旧口味承载着怀旧情绪与传统。测试向每一位品尝者隐藏了品牌，因此无法量化：这个品牌对那些极其忠诚的消费者，究竟意味着什么。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

unmarked adj.
未作标记的；未标品牌的
two unmarked beverages

beverage n.
饮料
unmarked beverages

preference n.
偏好；更喜欢的事物
state a preference.

palate n.
味觉；品味能力
judge by palate alone

publicity n.
宣传；公众关注
doubled as publicity.

thorough adj.
全面细致的；彻底的
thorough and extensive.

extensive adj.
广泛的；覆盖面大的
thorough and extensive.

formula n.
配方
a sweeter formula

wager n.
赌注；冒险之举
launching the concoction was a wager.

backlash n.
强烈反对；反弹
The backlash was a grassroots outcry.

grassroots adj.
基层的；普通民众自发的
a grassroots outcry.

outcry n.
强烈抗议；公愤
a grassroots outcry.

faithful adj.
忠实的
some faithful drinkers

lawsuit n.
诉讼
filed a lawsuit

dismissal n.
驳回（诉讼）
Its dismissal came a week later.

concession n.
让步
Coke's concession.

relaunch v.
重新推出；重新上市
relaunched as Coca-Cola Classic.

vindication n.
证明正确；获得认可
a vindication for loyalists.

misjudge v.
误判
misjudged what the tests measured.

attachment n.
依恋；情感联系
the emotional attachment

nostalgia n.
怀旧；对往昔的眷恋
nostalgia and heritage.

quantify v.
量化
could not quantify what it meant

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共30项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

booth n.
摊位；小亭

shopper n.
购物者

sip v.
小口喝；啜饮

taster n.
品尝者

consumer n.
消费者

syrup n.
糖浆

centenary n.
一百周年；百年纪念

soda n.
汽水

sweetness n.
甜味

flavour n.
味道；口味

concoction n.
调制品；混合饮料

hotline n.
热线电话

furious adj.
极其愤怒的

complaint n.
投诉；抱怨

protest group n.
抗议团体

organise v.
组织；筹组

chief executive n.
首席执行官

employee n.
员工

U-turn n.
彻底转向；政策大反转

loyalist n.
忠实拥护者

interrupt v.
打断；中断

broadcast v.
播报；广播

comeback n.
回归；复出

news bulletin n.
新闻简报；新闻节目

mouthful n.
一口的量

emotional adj.
情感的

familiarity n.
熟悉；熟悉感

heritage n.
传统；传承下来的事物

fiercely adv.
强烈地；极其

loyal adj.
忠诚的

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 Coca-Cola's testing was thorough and _____.

02 Its sweetness had given it a winning flavour, but launching the concoction was a _____.

03 Its _____ came a week later.

04 Coca-Cola had _____ what the tests measured.

文章主线

- 竞争 百事用不标品牌的试饮吸引消费者，通常更受青睐；可口可乐随后做了近20万次盲测。
- 换方 更甜的新配方在盲测中胜过旧版和百事，公司于1985年用它替换已有99年历史的老配方。
- 反弹 热线日来电从约400增至1500，几乎全是投诉；顾客囤积旧款、结社抗议，还有人起诉但被驳回。
- 回归 仅79天后，老配方以经典可口可乐之名回归，成为电视新闻头条。
- 漏测 盲测只比较一口饮料的味道，遗漏了品牌与熟悉口味承载的感情、怀旧和传统。

参考答案　1 extensive 2 wager 3 dismissal 4 misjudged